

# ENDOCRINE SYSTEM

The endocrine system is a slower, longer-lasting control system than the nervous system. It consists of glands that release hormones into your bloodstream to be delivered to specific cells.

## SYSTEM OVERVIEW

Your brain controls the release of hormones from endocrine glands to maintain a balance inside your body, called homeostasis. Stressors—from external environmental conditions to internal or emotional factors—affect this balance, but yoga can help. For example, research suggests that yoga may prevent and improve symptoms of type 2 diabetes.

**Pineal gland**  
*Makes melatonin, which affects sleep*

**Hypothalamus**  
*Controls other glands*

**Pituitary gland**  
*Produces key hormones*

**Parathyroid gland**  
*Regulates blood calcium levels*

**Thyroid gland**  
*Regulates metabolism and blood calcium*

**Heart**  
*Releases hormones to regulate blood pressure*

**Adrenal gland**  
*Regulates salt levels and produces adrenaline in response to danger*

**Pancreas**  
*Secretes insulin and glucagon to regulate blood sugar*

**Small intestine**  
*Releases hormones to help with digestion*

**Testis**  
*Produces male sex hormones*

*Ovaries produce female sex hormones*

FEMALE

MALE